60-Minute Roast Chicken Stock (Instant Pot)

A rotisserie chicken is stripped and its meat shredded fine, then pressure cooked 40 minutes with carrot, onion, and garlic—the extraction of six hours at a simmer, and clear because a sealed pot never boils. Makes about 5 cups of roast chicken stock.

Ingredients

Chicken fat, skimmed from a previous batch, or neutral oil . . . . . 1 Tbsp.
Carrot 1/4
Onion 1/4
Garlic cloves 1
Rotisserie chicken . . . . . 1/2 (about 1 1/2 lb.)
Water . . . . . 1 quart
Kosher salt . . . . . to taste (about 1/2 tsp. per quart)

Directions

Bring **water** to a boil — Slice **carrot** and **onion** thin — Smash **garlic** — Halve the **chicken** with kitchen shears and strip all of its meat, shredding it fine

1. Heat the **chicken fat** in the pressure cooker on sauté over medium heat for *1–2 minutes*. Add **carrot**, **onion**, and **garlic** and sweat for *5–8 minutes*, until they soften and take a little colour at the edges; drop the heat if they start to brown all over.

2. While the aromatics sweat, strip the meat from the 1/2 **rotisserie chicken** and shred it finely with your fingers or two forks; small pieces shorten the flavour's path out into the water. Add the **meat**, **bones**, and **skin** to the pot.

3. Pour in the boiling **water** and stir once. Seal the lid, set the valve to sealing, and cook on *high pressure* for *40 minutes*; the pot needs about *10 minutes* to reach pressure before that timer starts.

4. Switch the cooker off and let the pressure fall on its own, about *15–20 minutes*. To hurry it, crack the valve just enough to let a thin thread of steam out, never wide open: the superheated liquid flashes to a boil and churns fat and fine particles back into the stock.

5. Strain the **stock** through a fine-mesh strainer into a large bowl or 8-cup measuring cup and let it drain; do not press the solids, which hazes the stock. Discard them. You will have more than the quart of water you put in, about 5 cups, and it should taste of meat rather than bones.

6. Chill the **stock**, lift the pale cap of **fat** off the surface, and keep it in a jar for your next batch. Taste before seasoning: the rotisserie bird has already salted the pot, so add **kosher salt** only if the stock tastes flat—about 1/2 tsp. to a quart finishes it.

Yield

- Makes about 5 cups (1¼ quarts), more than the water that went in

Equipment Required

- 6-quart electric pressure cooker (Instant Pot) or stovetop pressure cooker; a full 2-quart batch wants an 8-quart
- Kitchen shears, two forks, cutting board, and chef's knife
- Fine-mesh strainer, and a large bowl or 8-cup measuring cup
- Measuring cups and spoons
- Storage containers, plus a small jar for the skimmed **fat**

Mise en Place

- Slice ¼ **onion** and ¼ **carrot** thin and smash 1 clove **garlic**; keep them together on the board
- Halve the **chicken**, strip and shred the meat, and break the carcass into pieces that fit the pot
- Bring 1 quart **water** to a boil, and set out a jar for the **fat** you skim at the end

Ingredient Tips

- **Rotisserie chicken**: a supermarket bird is the point of the recipe—already roasted and seasoned, so it brings both the roast flavour and the salt. Any roast carcass and its leftover meat will do
- **Chicken fat**: keep the fat you skim from each batch and it carries roast flavour into the next one. Any neutral oil substitutes
- **Kosher salt**: the amount assumes Diamond Crystal; Morton is denser, so use about half. Taste first, since the bird has done most of the work

Preparation Tips

- The shredding is the technique. Small pieces shorten the diffusion path, which is why this tastes like meat in *40 minutes* instead of after *6 hours* at a simmer
- For chicken, stay between *30* and *90 minutes*. Beyond about *3 hours* the bones break down and the stock turns metallic and bitter while the gelatin is chopped too fine to set
- Pressure holds the liquid below a boil, and that calm is what keeps the stock clear. A fast release undoes it
- A 6-quart cooker holds this half batch comfortably; double everything for a full batch and use an 8-quart, staying under the max-fill line
- An Instant Pot's high setting reaches about *240°F*, a stovetop cooker at 15 psi nearer *250°F*; the times here assume high pressure on either
- Judge it cold. The stock should set to a soft gel in the refrigerator, which is exactly what the consommé asks for

Make Ahead & Storage

- Keeps refrigerated *4–5 days*, frozen up to *3 months*; cool it uncovered and chill it fast
- Freeze in ice cube trays for portions—a cube or two drops straight into a pan sauce
- The skimmed **fat** keeps *2 weeks* refrigerated or *3 months* frozen
- Stock that stays liquid when cold was under-extracted or watered down; it still cooks well, it just will not body a sauce
- Best on the day it is made, while the roast notes are still bright

Serving Suggestions

- Pan sauces, soups, and risotto—anything that should taste of roast chicken
- Cook grains in it, or reduce it down with a splash of wine for a quick glaze
- A seasoned cup of it on its own is the flavour of a roast chicken without the bird

Source

- Adapted from Chris Young (Combustion Inc.; formerly The Fat Duck), via YouTube *$6 Michelin Stock in 60 Minutes (Costco Hack)*: `https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3k20zFlbFfE`